suba.lk

Every part of a Sri Lankan wedding, planned in one place.

Product, revenue, growth and redesign plan for turning the current invitation app into the country's main wedding hub.

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Prepared for the owners of suba.lk · Version 1 · 5 November 2026

Summary

The plan on one page

Couples in Sri Lanka still plan a wedding by asking relatives, scrolling Facebook pages and phoning vendors one by one. Prices are hidden, availability is a guess, and nothing is kept in one place. suba.lk becomes the one place where a couple plans, compares, books and invites.

16

services you listed, grouped into 5 sections: Plan, Find & book, Traditions, Invite and Finance.

7

ways to earn: invitations, vendor plans, booking commission, quote leads, featured listings, printing and loan referrals.

12 mo

to a working marketplace in 4 phases, starting with the invitation app you already have.

Three bets

- **Vendors before visitors.** A directory nobody lists in is useless. We sign up about 300 vendors in Colombo, Gampaha and Kandy before spending on couple marketing, starting with photographers, venues, decor, salons and wedding cars.
- **Free tools bring the traffic.** The budget planner, the nakath (auspicious time) calendar, price guides and invitations are free. People find them on Google, TikTok and WhatsApp, and that traffic feeds the vendor pages that make money.
- **Every invitation is an advert.** A wedding has about 300 guests, and each one opens a suba.lk link. Showing the couple's vendors on the invitation (with their permission) is our cheapest way to grow.

What we need to decide now

- Company structure, who owns what and who does what between the two owners. Register a private limited company before signing vendor contracts and the PayHere merchant agreement.
- Whether we take deposits (more revenue, but we handle refunds and disputes) or only pass leads to vendors at first. **Our recommendation: leads and quotes first, deposits from month 4.**
- A budget for the first 6 months: about two people building, one person signing up vendors, and a small budget for ads and content.

> **Before any marketing:** fix the 3 launch blockers in the current code: the hard-coded PayHere secret, uploads that are saved to the server's own disk, and missing rate limits on guest endpoints. Each is a few days' work at most.

Market and position

Why this can work in Sri Lanka

The size of the prize

Sri Lanka registers roughly **150,000 marriages a year** (check the latest Registrar General figure before quoting it). A typical Colombo-area wedding costs between **Rs. 1.5 and 6 million**, mostly spent on venue, catering, photography, decor, dress and cars.

If suba.lk is involved in 10% of weddings and takes 2–3% of what they spend through fees and commission, that is a business worth several hundred million rupees a year. Getting there takes years, but the ceiling is high.

How couples plan today

- Facebook and Instagram pages for each vendor, with prices only shared by DM.
- General classifieds sites, and word of mouth through family and friends.
- Phoning each vendor one by one to ask if the date is free.
- Spreadsheets or notebooks for the budget. Printed cards for invitations.

Who we serve

Who	What they need
Couples (25–35)	Clear prices, real reviews, free dates, one budget, less family stress.
Parents	Nakath and horoscope matching, trusted traditional services, Sinhala and Tamil.
Couples abroad	Plan a wedding at home from Australia, the UK or the Middle East. Willing to pay more.
Vendors	Steady bookings outside peak season, fewer time-wasting enquiries, a professional profile.
Guests and browsers	Ideas, price guides, dress and decor inspiration. This is where the traffic comes from.

Our position

Not just a directory, and not just an invitation tool. **suba.lk is where the plan lives**: the budget, bookings, guest list and invitations update each other. Directories can copy a vendor list. It is much harder to copy a couple's whole wedding plan.

> Sinhala, Tamil and English from day one, with Buddhist, Hindu, Muslim and Christian wedding traditions covered properly. Most competitors are English-only and Colombo-only.

Product

All 16 services, organised into 5 sections

Every vendor uses the same structure: a profile, packages with real prices, a calendar of free dates and reviews. That lets us add new categories without building new software each time. Each category uses one of three ways to connect couples with vendors: **Reserve** (pay a deposit for a date), **Quote** (send one request to up to 5 vendors) or **Contact** (call or WhatsApp, which we track as a lead).

Your request	Section	What we build	How couples connect	Phase
Centralised wedding hub	Home	Search by category, city and date. A personal "My wedding" workspace.	–	1
Generate wedding cards	Invite	The existing invitation editor, plus a printable card design (PDF).	Self-serve	1
Get cards printed	Invite	Send the card design to partner printers. Choose quantity and paper, get delivery.	Quote → order	2
Plan wedding expenses	Plan	Budget planner with typical Sri Lankan price ranges. Bookings update it automatically.	Free tool	1
Plan locations and venues	Find & book	Venue directory with filters for capacity, price per plate, area and free dates.	Quote / Reserve	1
Check photographer prices	Find & book	Package prices shown openly, plus a yearly price guide.	–	1
Reserve photographers	Find & book	Availability calendar and a deposit to hold the date.	Reserve	2
Vendor quotations	Find & book	One request goes to up to 5 vendors, and their quotes appear side by side.	Quote	1
Decorations	Find & book	Decorators, plus an ideas gallery where every photo links to the vendor who made it.	Quote	1
Horoscope readers (astrologers)	Traditions	Verified astrologers for horoscope matching and nakath. Book a consultation.	Contact / Reserve	2
Ashtaka performers	Traditions	Ashtaka performers and Jayamangala Gatha chanting groups, with audio samples.	Contact / Reserve	2
DJs	Find & book	DJs and bands (and Magul Bera drummers), with music samples and equipment lists.	Reserve	2
Wedding cars	Find & book	Car photos, price per trip or per day, decoration included or not.	Reserve	1
Salons	Find & book	Bridal dressing packages: Kandyan, Indian or Western saree, trials.	Reserve	1
Fragrance partners	Find & book	Perfume and wedding-favour partners. Bulk gift packs for guests.	Quote	2
Wedding loans	Finance	Compare loans from partner banks and finance companies, then apply on the lender's own site.	Referral	3

Phases: see the roadmap. Loans: suba.lk only refers couples and never lends, which keeps us outside CBSL lending rules (confirm with a lawyer).

Revenue

How suba.lk makes money

Couples should never pay to browse or plan, because free use is what brings traffic. Vendors pay because we send them bookings. The invitation app already earns from launch.

Income stream	Who pays	Price (to test)	Starts
Invitations	Couple	Rs. 2,900 / 4,900 / 8,900 one-off (current prices)	Now
Vendor plans	Vendor	Free basic listing · Pro Rs. 3,900/month · Premium Rs. 9,900/month	Month 3
Quote leads	Vendor (free plan)	Rs. 250–750 per quote request received, depending on category. Pro plans get unlimited leads.	Month 2
Booking commission	Vendor	6–10% of the deposit paid through suba.lk (not of the full wedding bill)	Month 4
Featured listings	Vendor	Top of a category in one city: Rs. 5,000–15,000/month. Always labelled "Featured".	Month 4
Card printing	Couple	15–25% margin on partner printer orders	Month 5
Loan referrals	Bank / finance company	A fixed fee per approved loan (agree the fee with each partner)	Month 8
Sponsorships	Brands, hotels	Price guides, wedding fairs and newsletter sponsorships	Month 6

Example numbers (all assumptions; we check them against real data every month)

End of	Vendors listed	Paying vendors	Invitations sold	Monthly revenue (Rs.)
Month 6	400	40	150 / mo	≈ 0.9 million
Month 12	1,200	180	400 / mo	≈ 3.2 million
Month 24	3,000	600	1,000 / mo	≈ 10 million

How month 12 adds up: 180 paying vendors × Rs. 5,500 on average = 0.99 million; 400 invitations × Rs. 4,000 = 1.6 million; commission and leads ≈ 0.4 million; featured listings and printing ≈ 0.2 million. These are planning numbers, not forecasts.

> **Pricing rule:** vendors should earn back the Pro fee from a single booking a month. If a vendor's Pro plan doesn't bring them at least one booking in 60 days, we offer a free month. Keeping vendors paying matters more than getting new ones to sign up.

Traffic and growth

Becoming the top wedding site in the country

1. Search (Google): the main traffic source

- **A page for every category in every city:** "wedding photographers in Kandy", "wedding cars in Galle", "Poruwa decorations in Negombo". With 25 cities, 16 categories and 3 languages, that is over 1,000 pages generated from real listings, each with prices and reviews.
- **The nakath calendar:** "Poruwa nakath 2027" is searched heavily every year. A free calendar of auspicious times, checked by our partner astrologers, brings parents to the site, and it is the main entry point to the Traditions section.
- **A yearly price guide:** "How much does a wedding photographer cost in Sri Lanka in 2027?", built from real vendor packages. News sites will link to it.
- **Pages in Sinhala and Tamil:** there is far less competition for searches in these languages.

2. Growth built into the product

- Each invitation reaches about 300 guests. A quiet "Made with suba.lk" line, plus credits for the couple's vendors on the invitation, can bring thousands of visits a month.
- Vendors share their suba.lk profile and reviews on their own pages, which advertises us for free.
- Shared budgets: the couple invites parents to view their budget plan, which brings in a second person.

3. Social media

- TikTok and Instagram Reels: real weddings, "what it really costs" breakdowns, vendor portraits. Three posts a week.
- Facebook groups where couples already plan. Answer questions there, don't spam.
- A WhatsApp channel with nakath dates and wedding-season deals.

4. Vendor sign-ups (on the ground)

- One full-time person signing up vendors, aiming for about 15 a day: visiting studios and salons, and meeting vendors at wedding fairs.
- Founding vendor offer: Pro free for 6 months and a "Founding vendor" badge for the first 300 vendors.
- We build their profile for them from their Facebook page in about 10 minutes, so they don't have to fill in anything.

5. Partnerships

- Hotel banquet teams, bridal fairs, and banks (loans and card offers).
- Sri Lankan community groups abroad, for couples planning a wedding back home.

Targets

By	Visits / month	Quote requests / month
Month 6	60,000	800
Month 12	250,000	4,000
Month 24	800,000	15,000

Redesign

Site structure and design direction

Main menu (the same on every page)

Section	Pages
Plan	Budget, checklist, guest list, nakath calendar
Find & book	Venues, photographers, decor, salons, cars, DJs, fragrance, other
Traditions	Astrologers, ashtaka, Magul Bera drummers, guides for each tradition
Invite	Online invitations, printed cards, RSVP
Ideas	Real weddings, price guides, inspiration
For vendors	List your business, plans, vendor dashboard

Web addresses (good for search)

`/si/photographers/kandy`
`/en/vendors/studio-lumiere`
`/en/plan/budget · /si/nakath/2027`
`/en/ideas/poruwa-decor`
`/app (the couple's workspace) · /vendor (the vendor's dashboard)`

What happens to the current app

The invitation editor, RSVP, seating, gallery and reminders stay as they are and become the **Invite** section of the couple's workspace. The current landing page is replaced by the hub home page. The marketing parts that break our design rules (sparkle icons, frosted-glass effects, about 570 hard-coded colours) are cleaned up at the same time.

Design direction

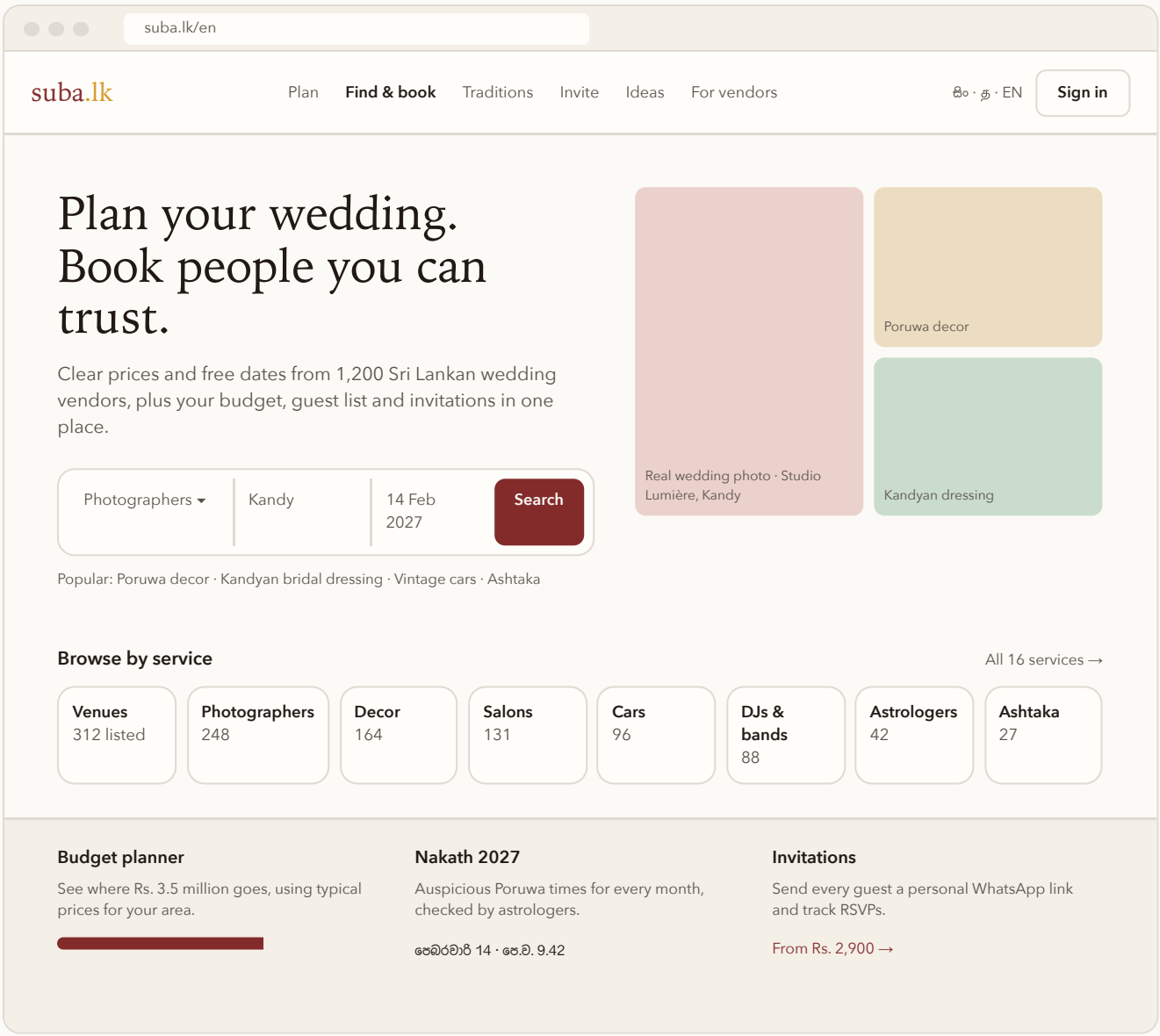
Calm, editorial and trustworthy, like a well-printed wedding programme. Photos of real work do the talking, and the layout stays out of the way.

Temple maroon *main colour*
Betel leaf *confirmed / free*
Brass *ratings, featured*
Ink *text*
Ivory *background*

- **Fonts:** a serif for headings, plain sans-serif for interface text, Noto Sans Sinhala and Noto Sans Tamil for those languages.
- **Prices are always visible** as "From Rs. 85,000". Showing real prices is what sets us apart.
- **One main button per screen:** "Request quote" or "Check date", never both.
- **Built for phones first** (360 px wide): filters open as a bottom sheet, buttons are at least 44 px, and pages load fast on 4G.
- **Trust signals:** verified badge, reviews only from couples who booked, response time, "member since".
- **Traditional decoration only where it belongs:** the moonstone motif on Traditions pages and invitation templates, never in dashboards.
- Keep the existing design rules: no gradients, no glass effects, no sparkle icons.

Mockup 1 of 6 · Home page, desktop

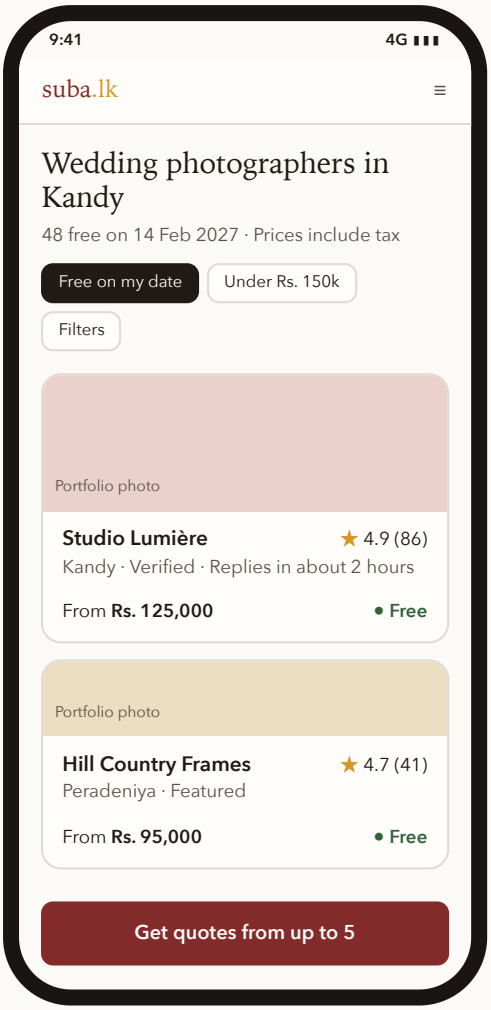
The hub home page



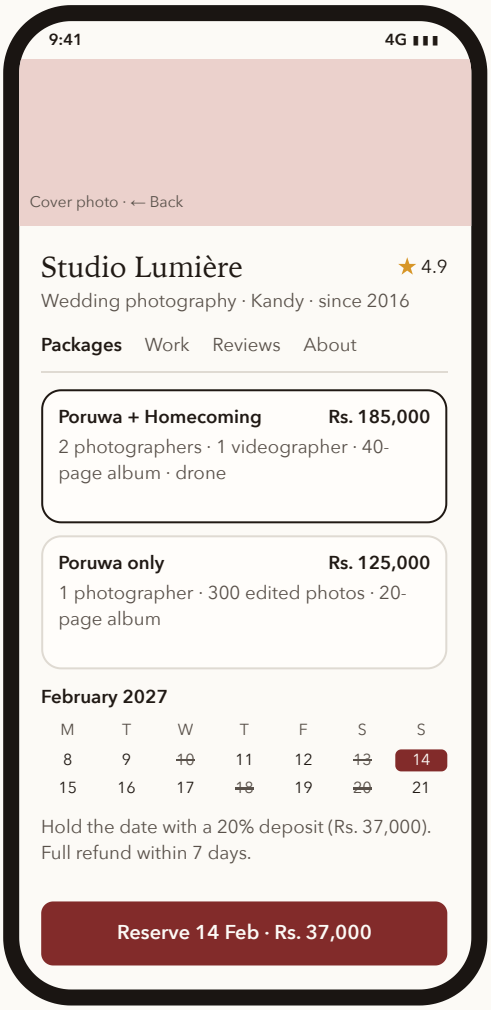
One clear starting point: search by service, city and date. Free tools sit below as the second way in. Vendor counts are shown so couples can see the site is busy. The figures shown are target numbers for month 12.

Mockups 2 and 3 of 6 · Search results and vendor profile, phone

Finding and booking a photographer



Search results: price, rating and whether the date is free are shown on every card. The button at the bottom sends one quote request to several photographers.

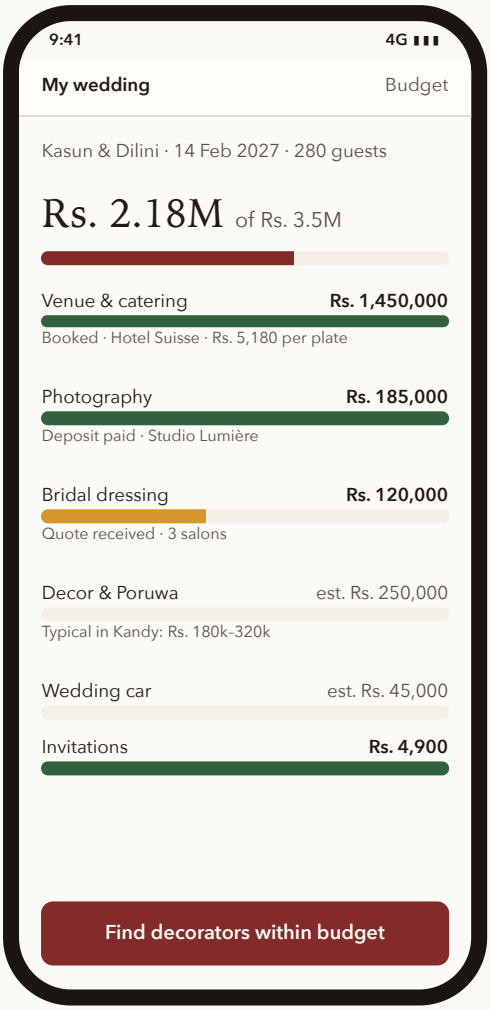


Vendor profile: packages with real prices, a calendar of free dates, and a reserve button that shows the deposit amount and refund terms up front.

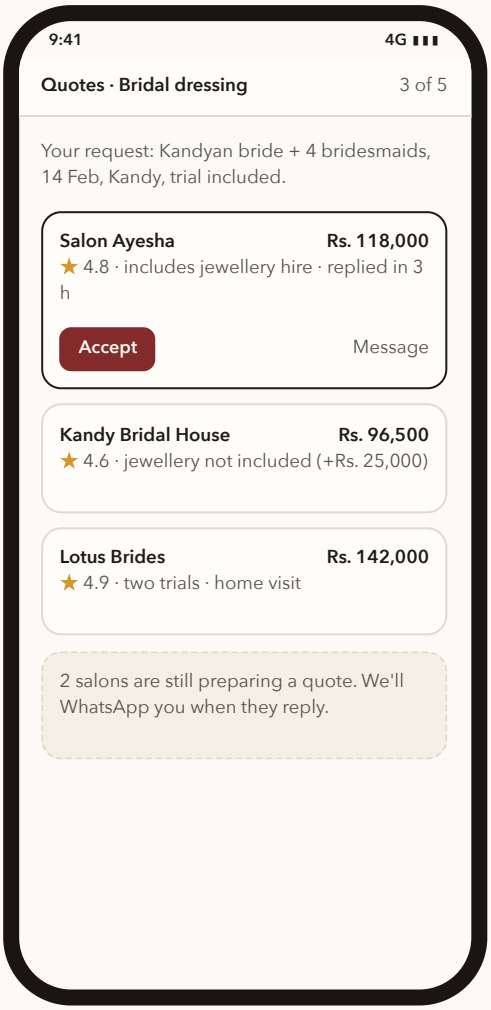
> Reviews can only be written by couples who booked through suba.lk, and each one is marked "Booked on suba.lk". This is the best protection against fake reviews and the main reason couples will trust the site.

Mockups 4 and 5 of 6 · Budget planner and quote comparison, phone

Planning the money, comparing the offers



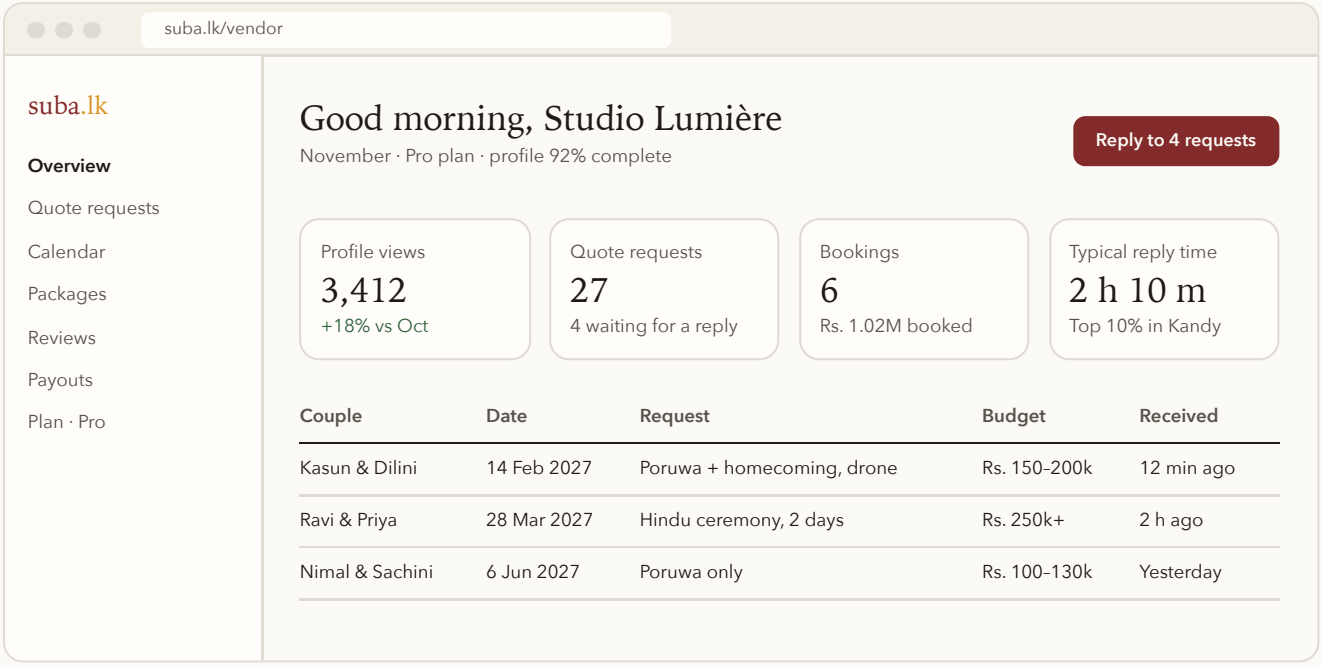
Budget planner: free and open without signing up. Each booking updates the totals automatically. Lines without a vendor yet show typical local prices and link straight to vendors in that price range.



Quote comparison: one request, quotes in the same format side by side, with what is and isn't included spelled out. Accepting a quote adds it to the budget.

Mockup 6 of 6 · Vendor dashboard, desktop

What vendors see, and why they pay



Why vendors pay for Pro: it shows them how many views and requests suba.lk sent, and how much they booked as a result. Seeing that it pays for itself is what keeps them subscribed. Fast replies help a vendor rank higher, so the service gets better for couples too.

The Traditions section works differently

Astrologers and nakath

Astrologers are checked before they're listed, and couples book a consultation with them (in person, by phone or by video), either to match horoscopes or to set the Poruwa time. The free nakath calendar is the main way people find this section. The tone stays respectful: no "lucky score" gimmicks.

Ashtaka and chanting

Each profile includes an audio sample, and couples can pick whether the ashtaka is performed in Sinhala or Pali. Booked together with Magul Bera drummers and Jayamangala Gatha groups. Most listings are in Sinhala, so these pages are written in Sinhala first.

Building it

Technical plan: build on what you already have

The current code (Next.js 16, Postgres with Drizzle, Better Auth, next-intl, PayHere) is a good foundation for a marketplace. We extend it rather than rewrite it. The invitation features stay as they are.

New database tables

Table	What it stores
vendors	The business profile, owner, city, verification status, plan
categories	The 16 services, with names in 3 languages
packages	Name, price, what's included, in 3 languages
availability	Dates a vendor is blocked or booked
quote_requests / quotes	Requests from couples and vendor replies
bookings	Deposit, status, refund state, PayHere order
reviews	Linked to a booking, so only real customers can review
weddings, budget_items	The couple's plan. Existing invitations link to it.
subscriptions, payouts	Vendor plans and what we owe vendors
leads	Phone and WhatsApp taps, so we can show vendors what we sent them

Main technical choices

- **Search:** start with the search built into Postgres (no extra service), then move to a dedicated search engine like Meilisearch once there are over 5,000 listings.
- **Photos:** Cloudflare R2 storage with uploads sent straight from the browser, resized automatically. This also fixes the current problem of uploads being saved on the server's own disk.
- **Payments:** PayHere for deposits and vendor plans. At first we pay vendors by weekly bank transfer and keep a record of every payment. Automatic splitting of payments can come later.
- **Messages:** WhatsApp click-to-chat links at first, then the official WhatsApp Business API for quote alerts.
- **Search engines:** pages are generated on the server, with structured data (LocalBusiness, AggregateRating, Offer) and a sitemap for each language.
- **Speed:** category pages are cached and refreshed every hour, so they stay fast on 4G.
- **Admin panel:** approve vendors, moderate reviews, handle disputes and refunds.

Fix before launch (from the code review)

- Remove the hard-coded PayHere secret that's used when the setting is missing.
- Move uploads to R2 and add rate limits.
- Pin package versions and replace hard-coded colours with design tokens.

Roadmap

Twelve months, four phases

Phase	What we ship	How we know it worked
0 · Clean-up Weeks 1–3	Fix the 3 launch blockers, launch the invitation app on suba.lk, set up analytics and Search Console, register the company and sign the PayHere merchant agreement.	First 20 paid invitations. No serious errors.
1 · Directory Months 1–3	New home page and navigation. Vendor profiles and packages. Venues, photographers, decor, salons and cars. Quote requests. Budget planner. Nakath 2027 calendar. City pages for search. Founding-vendor sign-up campaign.	300 live vendors, 20,000 visits a month, 300 quote requests a month, 50% of requests getting a reply within 24 hours.
2 · Bookings Months 4–6	Availability calendars and deposits via PayHere. Reviews from real bookings. Pro and Premium vendor plans, featured listings. DJs, astrologers, ashtaka, fragrance. Printed card orders with 2 partner printers.	40 paying vendors, 100 bookings a month, Rs. 0.9M monthly revenue.
3 · Scale Months 7–12	Wedding loans with 1–2 partner lenders. Installable phone app (PWA). WhatsApp Business alerts. Ideas section and real weddings. Full Tamil, Muslim and Christian wedding coverage. Expand to Galle, Kurunegala and Jaffna.	250,000 visits a month, 180 paying vendors, Rs. 3M+ monthly revenue.

Team (minimum)

- 2 developers (the owners). One focuses on the marketplace, the other on content and growth tools.
- 1 person signing up vendors, paid a base salary plus a bonus per paying vendor.
- 1 part-time content creator (Sinhala and English) for social media and price guides.
- Later: customer support for couples and vendors, and someone to handle disputes.

Numbers to track every week

- Live vendors in each category and city.
- Quote requests, the share that get a reply, and how fast.
- Bookings, and the value of deposits paid through us.
- Visits from Google, broken down by language.
- Vendors who stopped paying, and why.

Risks and next steps

What could go wrong, and what to do this week

Risk	What we do about it
Not enough vendors, so couples leave	Launch city by city and category by category. Only advertise a category once it has at least 15 real vendors in that city.
Vendors take bookings outside suba.lk	Charge mainly through plans and leads, not only commission. Give couples a reason to book on suba.lk: the deposit is protected, and only booked couples can leave reviews.
Deposit disputes and refunds	A written cancellation policy for every booking, deposits held until the agreed date, and one person who handles disputes.
Fake reviews or fake vendors	Only couples who booked can review. Vendors are verified (business registration or national ID, plus photos of real work).
Personal data (PDPA No. 9 of 2022)	Collect as little as possible, let people export or delete their data, set retention periods, and get a short review from a local lawyer.
Wedding loans and financial rules	We only refer couples. We never lend, take applications or hold borrowers' money. We sign a referral agreement with CBSL-licensed lenders only.
Sensitive traditional services	Use respectful wording, no fortune-telling gimmicks, and write the Traditions content with astrologers and cultural advisors.
Two owners, unclear roles	Write a shareholder agreement: who owns what share, who decides what, what happens if one owner leaves. Do this before taking money from anyone.

The next 7 days

- **Day 1–2:** both owners agree on this plan, the company structure and the 6-month budget.
- **Day 2–4:** fix the 3 launch blockers in the current code and put the invitation app live on suba.lk.
- **Day 3–7:** visit 30 vendors (photographers, salons, decorators) in one city. Ask what they pay for advertising today and whether they'd pay Rs. 3,900 a month for real leads. Write down every answer.
- **Day 5–7:** start building the vendor database tables and profile pages (Phase 1, week 1).

> The vendor interviews are the most important step this week. If fewer than 1 in 3 vendors would pay, change the prices before building the booking system.